educational institutions. ‘This was an especially urgent priority in the first years after Independence,’ argue Andersen and Damle. It was ‘prompted both by the growing demand for education on the part of the RSS’s largely urban, middle-class base and by the sangh’s conviction that national values were inadequately represented in the curriculum, both in public schools and in private Christian schools’.[89]

The RSS’s emphasis on education in local languages is the other side of the same coin: a battle against what it sees as a colonial legacy. For the RSS, if Japan and Germany could become economic powers without English, why not India? As a leading piece in *Organiser* argued in 2015, ‘It has been categorically proved through scientific research that education is best imparted through the mother tongue. Twenty nations with the highest GDP across the world use their own language as medium of education as well as governance. Only four nations—England, America, Australia and Canada—have English as their medium, for the simple reason that English is their mother tongue. On the other hand, the 20 most backward countries are the ones that have a foreign language or a mix of foreign and regional (like in India) as medium of education.’[90]

The RSS’s Akhil Bharatiya Pratinidhi Sabha (ABPS), its highest decision-making body, met in March 2018 and came out with a clear resolution on the preservation of Indian languages and dialects. As many as 1,496 pratinidhis (representatives) from various prants and Sangh associations signed on to the ‘need to protect and promote Bharatiya languages’. The ABPS lamented that ‘the declining trend in practice and usage of Bharatiya languages, elimination of their words and replacement by words of foreign languages are emerging as a serious challenge’. It demanded that ‘Primary education across the country should only be in mother tongue or any Bharatiya language. For this, parents should make up their mind and governments should formulate suitable policies.’ Furthermore, it called for teaching and study materials as well as examinations for higher education in technical and medical colleges to be in ‘Bharatiya languages too’. Finally, the RSS also wanted preference for Bharatiya languages in ‘all governmental and judicial works’ and asked that the ‘entire society including the Swayamsevaks should give preference to the mother tongue in conversations and day-to-